



File No.: EXP202309999

RESOLUTION OF RIGHTS PROCEDURE

Once the procedural actions provided for in Title VIII of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and the Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD) have been carried out, the following FACTS have been established:

FIRST: The complaining party exercised the right of Erasure against the respondent, and their request, as stated by the complaining party, did not receive the legally established response.

The complaining party provides various documentation related to the complaint filed with this Agency and regarding the exercise of the right exercised.

SECOND: Once the procedure established in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD was fulfilled, the complaint was admitted for processing, and the respondent entity was granted a hearing period of ten working days to present any arguments they deemed appropriate.

The respondent entity, during the formalized procedures, has demonstrated to this Agency that it has addressed the exercised right and sent the complaining party the appropriate response to their request.

LEGAL GROUNDS

I

Competence

In accordance with the powers granted to each supervisory authority by Article 58.2 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (General Data Protection Regulation, hereinafter GDPR), and as established in Articles 47, 48.1, and 64.1 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and the Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter, LOPDGDD), the Director of the Spanish Data Protection Agency is competent to initiate and resolve this procedure.

Furthermore, Article 63.2 of the LOPDGDD states: "The procedures processed by the Spanish Data Protection Agency shall be governed by the provisions of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, by this organic law, by the regulatory provisions issued for its development, and, in so far as they do not contradict them, by the general rules on administrative procedures."

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II

Preliminary Issues

In accordance with the provisions of Article 55 of the GDPR, the Spanish Data Protection Agency is competent to perform the functions assigned to it in Article 57, including enforcing the Regulation and promoting awareness among data controllers and processors regarding their obligations, as well as addressing complaints filed by data subjects and investigating, as appropriate, the reasons for such complaints.

Correspondingly, Article 31 of the GDPR establishes the obligation of data controllers and processors to cooperate with the supervisory authority that requests it in the performance of its functions. In cases where they have designated a data protection officer, Article 39 of the GDPR assigns this officer the function of cooperating with that authority.

In accordance with this regulation, following the procedure established in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD, prior to the admission of the complaint regarding the exercise of the rights regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, which gives rise to this procedure, the complaint was forwarded to the respondent party for analysis, to respond to this Agency within one month, and to demonstrate that they had provided the complaining party with the appropriate response.

The result of this forwarding did not allow for an understanding that the claims of the complaining party

were satisfied. Consequently, on September 27, 2023, for the purposes provided for in Articles 64.1 and 65 of the LOPDGDD, the complaint was admitted for processing. This admission for processing determines the opening of the present procedure for failure to address a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, regulated in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, which states:

"When the procedure refers exclusively to the failure to address a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council, of April 27, 2016, it shall be initiated by an admission agreement, which shall be adopted in accordance with the provisions of Article 65 of this organic law.

In this case, the deadline for resolving the procedure shall be six months from the date on which the admission agreement was notified to the complaining party. After this period, the interested party may consider their complaint accepted."

Article 58.2 of the GDPR grants the Spanish Data Protection Agency a series of corrective powers to correct any infringement of the GDPR, including "ordering the data controller or processor to address the requests for the exercise of the rights of the data subject under this Regulation."

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III

Rights of Individuals Regarding Personal Data Protection

The rights of individuals regarding personal data protection are regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR and Articles 13 to 18 of the LOPDGDD. These rights include the rights of access, rectification, erasure, objection, the right to restriction of processing, and the right to data portability.

The formal aspects related to the exercise of these rights are established in Articles 12 of the GDPR and 12 of the LOPDGDD.

Additionally, the provisions expressed in Recitals 59 and following of the GDPR are taken into account.

In accordance with the provisions of these regulations, the data controller must establish means and mechanisms to facilitate the exercise of rights by the data subject, which shall be free of charge (without prejudice to the provisions of Articles 12.5 and 15.3 of the GDPR), and is obliged to respond to requests made no later than one month, unless it can demonstrate that it is unable to identify the data subject, and to state its reasons in case it does not intend to comply with such request. The burden of proof regarding compliance with the obligation to respond to the request for the exercise of rights made by the affected party lies with the data controller.

The communication addressed to the data subject regarding their request must be expressed in a concise, transparent, intelligible, and easily accessible manner, using clear and simple language.

IV

Conclusion

In the case analyzed here, the claimant exercised their right to Erasure regulated in Article 17 of the GDPR and Article 15 of the LOPDGDD.

Once the period established in accordance with the aforementioned regulations had elapsed, their request did not receive the legally required response.

The aforementioned regulations do not allow the request to be overlooked as if it had not been made, leaving it without the response that the data controllers are obliged to issue, even in cases where there are no data of the data subject in the entity's files or even in those cases where the requirements set forth are not met, in which case the recipient of such request is also obliged to require the correction of the observed deficiencies or, if applicable, to deny the request with justification indicating the reasons why the right in question cannot be considered.

Therefore, the request made obliges the controller to provide an express response, in any case, using any means that justifies the receipt of the response.

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In this case, however, it is noted that during the processing of the complaint that gives rise to this procedure, formulated precisely due to the lack of an adequate response to the request for the exercise of rights, the respondent has provided documentation proving the communication sent to the data subject addressing the right or informing about the decision made regarding the request. This response, therefore, occurs after the established deadline has passed.

In this regard, it should be clarified that the response that corresponds to be made cannot be expressed merely as part of an administrative procedure. Consequently, considering that the purpose of this procedure is to ensure that the guarantees and rights of the affected parties are duly restored, combining the information contained in the file with the regulations referred to in the preceding sections, it is appropriate to uphold the present complaint on formal grounds due to the response being issued late, without requiring the data controller to carry out additional actions to issue a new certification regarding the attention to the right.

In view of the cited provisions and others of general application,
the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection RESOLVES:

FIRST: TO UPHOLD on formal grounds the complaint filed by A.A.A. against VOX ESPAÑA, with NIF G86867108. However, it is not appropriate to issue a new certification by said entity, as the response was issued late, without requiring the performance of additional actions by the controller.

SECOND: TO NOTIFY this resolution to A.A.A. and to VOX ESPAÑA.

In accordance with the provisions of Article 50 of the LOPDGDD, this Resolution will be made public once it has been notified to the interested parties.

Against this resolution, which concludes the administrative procedure in accordance with Article 48.6 of the LOPDGDD, and in accordance with the provisions of Article 123 of the LPACAP, the interested parties may optionally file a motion for reconsideration before the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection within one month from the day following the notification of this resolution or directly file a contentious-administrative appeal before the Contentious-Administrative Chamber of the National Court, in accordance with the provisions of Article 25 and Section 5 of the fourth additional provision of Law 29/1998, of July 13, regulating the Contentious-Administrative Jurisdiction, within two months from the day following the notification of this act, as provided in Article 46.1 of the aforementioned Law.

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